Mesa
SCHOOL OF BUSINESS

The ₹30,000 Pitch

How to walk into the M1 review and walk out with capital.

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Ninety minutes. You leave with a submitted deck.

01 What happens at the M1 review, and what gets scored

02 You are pitching a lender, not an investor

03 The nine slides, and what each one has to prove

04 Build your deck, with your real numbers

05 Three teams pitch, the room decides

Someone pitch me your business. 60 seconds.

THE ROOM'S ONLY JOB WHILE THEY LISTEN

Would you lend them ₹30,000 of your own money?

Six boxes. All six, or no money.

1

Product and supplier locked

With a named backup and known lead times

2

Demand validated

Through pre-orders or comparable evidence — *not opinion*

3

Unit economics clear

And the margin supports a 4× return

4

A credible path to ₹4L

Across online, offline and B2B

5

First order right-sized

So cash is protected

6

Seven-day action list

And named first customers

Three numbers, and one consequence.

₹30,000 released this week if you clear the gate

₹2,000 penalty if your product-and-supplier submission is rejected

7 weeks to turn it into ₹4,00,000 and pay it back

Rejected teams don't just wait. Mesa assigns you a product and a supplier — and you sell someone else's idea for seven weeks.

You are not pitching an investor. You're pitching a lender.

AN INVESTOR	YOUR MENTOR
Buys a share of your upside	Lends you money that must come back
Funds a story about the future	Funds evidence from the last two weeks
Wants the one outlier in thirty	Wants all twenty teams to repay
Asks “how big could this get?”	Asks “how do I know I'll get this back?”
Forgives failure — it’s priced in	30 September. Full repayment. Credit loss if not.

Three questions. Most teams fail on the same one.

“Show me the concrete path to ₹4L.”

Testing: is there arithmetic, or a hope?

“What's your first-order quantity and cash plan?”

Testing: will you burn the whole tranche on stock?

“Who are your first ten customers?”

Testing: names, or “our network”?

If your answer to any of these starts with “we’re planning to” — you don’t have an answer yet.

Nine slides. Each one clears a gate.

#	SLIDE	THE ONE-LINE JOB	CLEARS
1	**Cover**	Who you are, in ten seconds	—
2	**Problem / Solution / Alternatives**	Make me feel the pain, then the fix	—
3	**Pitch & USP + your customer**	One sentence, and exactly who buys	—
4	**Product Portfolio**	Show me the thing	—
5	**Proof of Demand** NEW	Evidence, not opinion	Gate 2
6	**Readiness Checklist**	Product and supplier locked, backup named	Gate 1
7	**Unit Economics & First Order** NEW	The margin, and what you'll actually buy	Gates 3 & 5
8	**The ₹4L Roadmap**	The arithmetic, channel by channel	Gate 4
9	**The Ask & Next 7 Days** NEW	₹30,000 broken down, ten customers named	Gate 6

Evidence first, then readiness.

SLIDE 5 · PROOF OF DEMAND

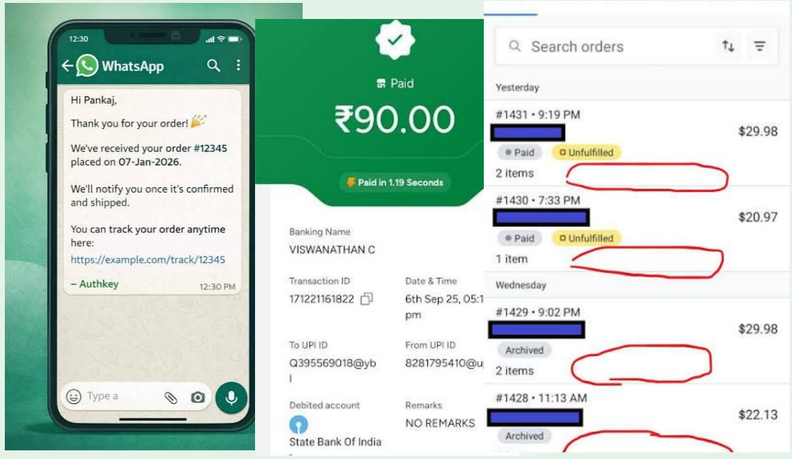
NEW

Paid pre-orders — count and value. *Only paid counts.*

What you've already sold, to whom, on what date

Comparable evidence: competitor review volumes, Google Trends, a waitlist, a WhatsApp poll with names

"We showed 30 people and 22 said they'd buy" is opinion. **"Eleven people paid ₹499 before we had stock" is evidence.**



SLIDE 6 · READINESS CHECKLIST

Number of SKUs · physical sample in hand — bring it to the review

Primary supplier: name, location, price, MOQ, lead time — *in writing*

Backup supplier: name, location, second quote in hand

Logo · tagline · packaging direction · B2B pitch

No named backup = automatic "not yet." This is the handbook's own red flag.

The margin, the maths and the ask.

SLIDE 7 · UNIT ECONOMICS NEW

Landed cost · packaging · shipping · payment fees = **true COGS**

Selling price, gross margin per unit

First order: MOQ × landed cost = **₹X of the ₹30,000**

What's left, and what it's for

From WS1 — your cost is never just the landed cost.

SLIDE 8 · THE ₹4L ROADMAP

Four channels × seven weeks, in rupees

Offline direct · social · B2B · Shopify — and the Flea in Week 7

Every cell is a number. A blank cell is a channel you haven't thought about.

SLIDE 9 · THE ASK NEW

₹30,000 broken into line items

Ten named first customers, with channel and date

Seven-day action list, owner against each line

This is the slide your mentor writes the decision on.

₹4,00,000 is not a target. It's a division problem.

Target	₹4,00,000
÷ your AOV	₹800
= orders needed	500
÷ 7 weeks	~71 a week
÷ 7 days	~10 a day

At a ₹350 AOV, the same target is 1,143 orders — 163 a week.

Your AOV is not a pricing decision. It's how hard the next seven weeks are.

Do this division before you build slide 8. If the weekly number is impossible, your problem isn't the pitch.

Spend it all on stock and you've bought a warehouse, not a business.



THE TRAP

₹30,000 → inventory. No samples, no ads, no packaging, and nothing left if demand disappoints.

A DEFENSIBLE PLAN — ILLUSTRATIVE

First order — 100 units × ₹150 landed	**₹15,000**
Samples and shipping	**₹1,500**
Packaging and inserts	**₹3,000**
First ad test	**₹5,000**
Buffer / reorder on the winner	**₹5,500**
Total	**₹30,000**

Showing what you're *not* spending is a credibility signal. It tells your mentor you've thought about being wrong.

“Our network” is not an answer.

WORKED EXAMPLE

#	NAME	CHANNEL	VALUE
1	Meera’s mother’s kitty group (14 people) · 3 Aug	Offline direct	₹6,000
2	Arjun — hostel floor, 40 rooms · 2 Aug	Offline direct	₹2,500
3	Café Nirvana, Indiranagar · 5 Aug	B2B	₹9,000

Ten rows. Real names. If you can’t fill ten, you have your homework for tonight.

YOURS — PHOTOGRAPH THIS

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

10

Five rules. Break them and you'll hear “not yet.”

1. **Numbers over adjectives** “₹150 landed, ₹499 price, 3.3×” beats “healthy margins” every time
2. **Evidence over intention** what you've done, not what you’ll do in seven
3. **Named over general** one real customer with a date beats a market size
4. **Right-sized over ambitious** restraint on the first order buys you the second tranche
5. **“I'll find out” over bluffing** a made-up number is the fastest way to lose the room

AI writes the sentences. You bring the evidence.

TOOL	USE IT FOR
Claude	Slide copy — paste your numbers, get three versions of the ask
Canva AI	Design the slide, and product mockups for slide 4
Gemini	Sharpen the problem statement

A PROMPT YOU CAN STEAL

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I'm pitching my college's investment committee for ₹30,000
of interest-free debt for [brand], a D2C [product] brand.
Repayable in 7 weeks. So far: [X] paid pre-orders worth
₹[Y], landed cost ₹[Z], selling at ₹[P]. Write me a
3-bullet "proof of demand" slide. Evidence only — cut
anything that's a plan rather than something that has
happened.
```

AI cannot invent your pre-orders. Every number on your deck must be one you can defend for ten minutes.

Nine slides, your real numbers, by Wednesday 10pm.

- [ ] Cover — brand, one-liner, team
- [ ] Problem / Solution / Alternatives
- [ ] Pitch & USP + exactly who buys
- [ ] Product portfolio — 3 images, 1 video
- [ ] **Proof of demand — paid orders, with dates**
- [ ] **Readiness — supplier + backup, both named**
- [ ] **Unit economics + first order sizing**
- [ ] **₹4L roadmap — every cell filled**
- [ ] **₹30,000 broken down + ten named customers**

FILL IN YOUR REAL NUMBERS

AOV ₹	Orders needed	
Per week	Landed cost ₹	
Price ₹	Margin ×	MOQ
First order ₹		

COMPLETE THIS SENTENCE

“We're asking for ₹30,000 to buy , which we'll sell through , returning ₹ by 30 September.”

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Go get your ₹30,000.

Wednesday, 10pm	Idea submission deadline — deck to outclass@pg27.mesaschool.co
Thursday & Friday	Pitching days — 10–15 minutes with your mentor, written decision
Saturday	Website v1 — WS4
Bring	Your physical sample, your supplier quotes, your numbers in your head

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